



Ministers responsible for Maritime Affairs signed the Lefkosia Declaration

Article / 29 April 2026

▶ Listen · 2:50 minutes

EU ministers meeting in Lefkosia have endorsed the Lefkosia Declaration, placing people at the heart of maritime policy while committing to a competitive, sustainable and socially responsible future for European shipping.

The Declaration was signed during the informal Transport, Telecommunications and Energy Council meeting (Maritime Affairs), which took place on 29 April 2026 at the Filoxenia



Cyprus Presidency
Council of the European Union

The Declaration places people at the centre of maritime policy. It focuses on strengthening seafarers' education and training, re-skilling and up-skilling in view of the green and digital transitions, promoting seafaring and maritime professions and the equal participation of women in the maritime sector.

At a time of increased geopolitical challenges and rapid transformation, the ministerial meeting and the signature of the Lefkosia Declaration send a clear political message of unity and commitment: that European shipping can be competitive, sustainable and at the same time socially responsible.



“The Lefkosia Declaration represents a meaningful step towards a European maritime sector that is resilient, competitive, sustainable and socially responsible. Above all, it points towards a maritime sector that recognises its people as its most valuable asset.”

Marina Hadjimanolis

Shipping Deputy Minister to the
President of the Republic of
Cyprus

During the Council meeting, the discussion focused on the Lefkosia Declaration about enhancing seafarers' education and training, as well as promoting the equal participation of women in the shipping industry, which the ministers signed after the exchange of views.

The Lefkosia Declaration reflects a shared political commitment to strengthening the human dimension of Europe's maritime sector, recognising that Europe's



Deputy Minister Hadjimanolis signs the Lefkosia Declaration

Throughout the discussion, EU ministers had the opportunity to exchange views on key challenges and priorities related to maritime skills, training, working conditions and gender equality, sending a clear collective political message in support of a socially sustainable European maritime sector, ready to embrace the future.

On the sidelines of the Council, an award ceremony also took place for the winners of the European School Competition entitled “The Ship of the Future – My Ship in 60 years”, organised by the European Community Shipowners’ Associations.

Photos

See photos from the event on the [Cyprus Presidency's Flickr account](#) .

Summary of the Lefkosia Declaration



Lefkosia Declaration Summary
29.04.2026

PDF - 349Kb

Download document ↓

Press conference video



Cyprus Presidency
Council of the European Union



Statements by Deputy Minister Hadjimanolis during a joint press conference with the Minister of Transport, Communications and Works, and the European Commissioner of Sustainable Transport and Tourism

Share this page



Related news

[See news →](#)



30 June 2026 | [Press release](#)

Council and Parliament agree on clarified rules for road tolls and user charges for heavy-duty vehicles



Cyprus Presidency
Council of the European Union



Information

- About this site
- Personal data
- Manage cookies
- Accessibility policy
- Contact
- ✉ Email subscription

Services

- gov.cy
- Presidency of the Republic of Cyprus
- Parliamentary dimension
- Visit Cyprus



- European Commission
- European Parliament
- European Council